

Saturday, 22 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 21° 13°	BIRMINGHAM Light drizzle 19° 12°	MANCHESTER Light drizzle 19° 13°	GLASGOW Overcast 18° 11°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Prince Harry and six other high-profile individuals have been ordered to pay an initial £9.5 million to the publisher of the Daily Mail.

This comes after they lost their High Court privacy case. There's a possibility they could be liable for up to £25 million more in legal costs.

COURT CASE · UK
- 2

Health officials are advising under-fives and pregnant women to avoid runny eggs when eating out due to a salmonella risk.

The guidance also extends to over-65s and those with underlying health conditions. This follows a recent salmonella outbreak.

HEALTH · UK
- 3

The UK Home Office says French authorities are becoming more effective at stopping small boat crossings in the Channel.

They credit new tactics with intercepting hundreds of potential crossings this summer. It suggests improved cooperation between the two nations.

MIGRATION · UK
- 4

The UK government borrowed more than expected in July, as Chancellor John Healey prepares for his first Budget.

Mr Healey has stated the government is 'committed to meeting our fiscal rules'. This news will be closely watched ahead of the upcoming financial statement.

POLITICS · UK
- 5

A man has been found guilty of murdering his estranged wife, Tania, after tracking her down on a night out.

Raymond Williams killed Tania after locating her with friends. This tragic case highlights the dangers of domestic abuse.

CRIME · UK

What's coming up

- 1** **There are reports that Meghan, the Duchess of Sussex, could return to acting once she's back in the UK.**
Sources close to the Sussexes haven't denied that she's been offered a role. This would be a big career move for her.

ON AIR – Would you be excited to see Meghan back on screen? What kind of role do you think she should take?
ROYAL · COMING UP
- 2** **Former wrestler Dave Bautista has been confirmed as the new star of the upcoming 'God of War' adaptation!**
He'll be taking over from Ryan Hurst as Kratos in the highly anticipated series. Fans of the popular PlayStation game will be keen to see him in action.

ON AIR – What do you think of Dave Bautista as Kratos? Is he the right choice for such an iconic character?
TV · COMING UP
- 3** **Priyanka Chopra Jonas has executive produced a new film about love and caste inequality, called 'The Cycle of Love'.**
It's based on the incredible true story of an Indian artist who cycled from India to Europe to reunite with his wife. Sounds like a powerful and inspiring story!

ON AIR – Have you heard of 'The Cycle of Love'? It sounds like a really moving story – would you watch it?
FILM · COMING UP
- 4** **Musical icon Angélique Kidjo has made Hollywood Walk of Fame history, dedicating her star to Africa!**
The artist from Benin spoke about how important Africa and Africans are to music. A wonderful moment for her and the continent.

ON AIR – What a fantastic achievement for Angélique Kidjo! Who else do you think deserves a star on the Hollywood Walk of Fame?
MUSIC · WHEN
- 5** **The Mahrajan Festival is making its debut in London, celebrating Arabic culture and music!**
With artists like Saint Levant and Dystinct performing, it's being hailed as a 'milestone' for the Arabic community. Sounds like a vibrant new event.

ON AIR – Are you planning to check out the Mahrajan Festival in London? What other cultural festivals are you looking forward to this summer?
MUSIC · COMING UP

On the schedule

1 **Tyson Fury says his highly anticipated fight with Anthony Joshua "doesn't look like it's going to happen."**

Fury made the comments in a social media tirade aimed at his British rival and promoter Eddie Hearn. It's a blow for boxing fans hoping to see the heavyweight clash.

ON AIR – Are you disappointed the Fury-Joshua fight might not happen? Who would you like to see them fight next instead?

BOXING · UK

2 **World number one Jannik Sinner has pulled out of the upcoming US Open due to a knee injury.**

This is a big blow for the Italian star and for the tournament. It leaves the men's draw wide open.

ON AIR – How much of an impact will Jannik Sinner's absence have on the US Open? Who do you think benefits most from him pulling out?

TENNIS · THIS WEEK

3 **England's Josh Tongue took three wickets in just six balls as Pakistan collapsed in their first Test.**

Pakistan fell from 68-3 to 76-6, putting England firmly in control at Headingley. England are now closing in on an innings victory.

ON AIR – What a spell from Josh Tongue! Is this the kind of performance that could make him a regular in the England team?

CRICKET · UK

4 **Tottenham have reportedly agreed a £75 million deal to sign Savinho, after the winger apparently wanted to leave Manchester City.**

Spurs boss Enzo Maresca confirmed the player's desire to move. This would be a significant signing for Tottenham.

ON AIR – £75 million for Savinho! Is he worth that price tag, and what will he bring to Tottenham?

FOOTBALL · UK

5 **Mercedes' Kimi Antonelli led McLaren's Lando Norris in the first practice session at the Dutch Grand Prix.**

The action is underway at Zandvoort, setting the stage for an exciting race weekend. All eyes will be on qualifying later today.

ON AIR – Antonelli leading Norris in practice – could we see a new face on the podium this weekend? Who are you backing for the Dutch Grand Prix?

F1 · THIS WEEK

Quick hits

- 1 A new trend sees more people embracing 'wild swimming' in natural bodies of water.**
Beyond the health benefits, enthusiasts report a significant boost in mood and a stronger connection to nature. It's becoming a refreshing way to unwind and experience the great outdoors.
- 2 The humble art of 'doodling' is being recognised for its surprising cognitive benefits.**
Far from being a sign of distraction, experts suggest that a bit of casual sketching can actually help focus and memory retention. So, next time you're on a long call, feel free to doodle away!
- 3 Community 'seed swaps' are sprouting up across the country, fostering local gardening initiatives.**
These events allow gardeners to exchange seeds, share tips, and grow a wider variety of plants. It's a wonderful way to connect with neighbours and cultivate a greener community.
- 4 Research shows that taking up a 'new craft hobby' can significantly reduce everyday stress.**
Whether it's knitting, pottery, or model-making, engaging in a hands-on activity provides a calming focus and a sense of accomplishment. It's a lovely antidote to screen time.
- 5 The simple joy of 'writing a letter by hand' is making a quiet comeback.**
In an age of instant messages, a thoughtful, handwritten note offers a personal touch that truly stands out. Many are rediscovering the charm of traditional correspondence.
- 6 More people are finding delight in 'birdwatching from their own garden'.**
Setting up a bird feeder or a simple bird bath can transform your outdoor space into a vibrant haven. It's a peaceful way to observe nature from the comfort of home.
- 7 A charming movement encouraging 'random acts of kindness' is spreading across towns and cities.**
From leaving a friendly note for a neighbour to paying for someone's coffee, these small gestures create a ripple effect of positivity. It's all about brightening someone's day unexpectedly.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new piece of technology is working correctly, even if it's just a light switch?

ANSWER: GENTLY TAPPING IT A FEW TIMES, JUST TO BE SURE!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, hot cup of tea or coffee.

ANSWER: STIRRING IT CLOCKWISE THREE TIMES, THEN ANTI-CLOCKWISE THREE TIMES, FOR OPTIMAL FLAVOUR DISTRIBUTION!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes a 'particular sound' just instantly brings you a sense of calm, or reminds you of a really happy, peaceful moment?**
Whether it's the gentle pitter-patter of rain, the distant sound of church bells, or even the purr of a cat, what's that one sound that just makes you feel good?

- **We all have those 'little tricks or shortcuts' we use around the house that we think are just brilliant, even if nobody else quite understands them, don't we?**
From an unusual way to fold laundry to a quirky method for opening jars, what's your secret domestic hack that you swear by?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that the 'smell of freshly cut grass' is actually a plant distress signal?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** It's said that 'chickens can actually dream in full colour' and often have visions of cornfields and tasty worms.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The tiny pocket on jeans was originally designed for pocket watches.
- A group of owls is called a parliament.
- The King of Hearts is the only king in a deck of cards without a moustache.
- The Great Wall of China is not visible from space with the naked eye.
- The highest mountain in the British Isles is Ben Nevis in Scotland.
- Strawberries are the only fruit with seeds on the outside.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time: 1/100th of a second.
- The national animal of Scotland is the unicorn.

On this day

Day 234 of the year, 131 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Immaculate Heart of Mary (Roman Catholic calendar of 1960); Christian feast day: John Kemble; Christian feast day: Queenship of Mary; Christian feast day: Blessed Symeon Lukach. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1973 — Howie Dorough, American singer-songwriter and dancer
- 1967 — Layne Staley, American singer-songwriter (died 2002)
- 1972 — Paul Doucette, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and drummer
- 1961 — Roland Orzabal, English singer and musician
- 1947 — Cindy Williams, American actress and producer (died 2023)
- 1945 — Ron Dante, American singer-songwriter and producer
- 1967 — Ty Burrell, American actor and comedian
- 1957 — Holly Dunn, American country music singer-songwriter (died 2016)

THE DAY TODAY

- 2006 — Pulkovo Aviation Enterprise Flight 612 crashes near the Russian border over eastern Ukraine, killing all 170 people on board.
- 1953 — The penal colony on Devil's Island is permanently closed.
- 1972 — Rhodesia is expelled by the IOC for its racist policies.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1989 — Nolan Ryan strikes out Rickey Henderson to become the first Major League Baseball pitcher to record 5,000 strikeouts.
- 2003 — Chief Justice of the Supreme Court of Alabama Roy Moore is suspended after refusing to comply with a federal court order to remove a rock inscribed with the Ten Commandments from the lobby of the Alabama Supreme Court building.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2004 — Versions of The Scream and Madonna, two paintings by Edvard Munch, are stolen at gunpoint from a museum in Oslo, Norway.

1981 — Far Eastern Air Transport Flight 103 disintegrates in mid-air and crashes in Sanyi Township, Miaoli County, Taiwan. All 110 people on board are killed.

- 1985 — British Airtours Flight 28M suffers an engine fire during takeoff at Manchester Airport. The pilots abort but due to inefficient evacuation procedures 55 people are killed, mostly from smoke inhalation.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 235 of the year, 130 days left in 2026. Today Battle of Kursk Day (Russia); Christian feast day: Ascelina; Christian feast day: Asterius, Claudius, and Neon; Christian feast day: Éogan of Ardstraw. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1986 — Neil Cicierega, American comedian and musician
- 1983 — James Collins, Welsh footballer
- 1992 — Nicola Docherty, Scottish footballer
- 1960 — Gary Hoey, American guitarist, songwriter, and producer
- 1970 — Jay Mohr, American actor, producer, and screenwriter
- 1974 — Ray Park, Scottish actor and stuntman
- 1972 — Martin Grainger, English footballer and manager
- 1986 — Sky Blu, American rapper and DJ

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1954 — The Cruise of the Kings, a royal cruise organised by the Queen Consort of Greece, Frederica of Hanover, departs from Marseille, France.
- 2007 — The skeletal remains of Russia's last royal family members Alexei Nikolaevich, Tsarevich of Russia, and his sister Grand Duchess Anastasia are discovered near Yekaterinburg, Russia.
- 1966 — Lunar Orbiter 1 takes the first photograph of Earth from orbit around the Moon.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1975 — The start of the Wave Hill walk-off by Gurindji people in Australia, lasting eight years, a landmark event in the history of Indigenous land rights in Australia, commemorated in a 1991 Paul Kelly song and an annual celebration.
- 2023 — A business jet carrying key leadership members of the Russian private military company Wagner Group crashes, killing all ten people on board.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar

AUGUST 2026

22–23

Belgian Grand Prix (F1)